

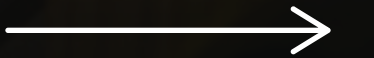
CAROLINE BLAZEK

RESEARCH, STRATEGY &
CONTENT DESIGN FOR
KATONAH WINE & LIQUOR

Instagram Content Strategy

CASE STUDY

SUMMER 2026



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A trusted *local resource* for discovering wine, spirits & cocktails.

THE CHALLENGE

Katonah Wine & Liquor is an independent shop competing against chain retailers, delivery apps, and the assumption that a liquor store is somewhere you get in and out of. The account was mostly straightforward bottle photos taken to promote tastings, with little visual consistency beyond the store’s logo.

THE GOAL

Position the store as a knowledgeable but approachable local resource for discovering wine, spirits, and cocktails, while building a stronger connection with the Katonah community and bringing more people to tastings and events.

CLIENT

Katonah Wine & Liquor

SCOPE

Research, strategy, content design

CHANNELS

Instagram, in-store print

TIMELINE

June–August 2026

What the *research* says

After reviewing current liquor store marketing trends across multiple sources, three themes appeared consistently. Independent stores are finding success by focusing on community, education, and personality rather than simply promoting products.

INSIGHT 01

People, *not Bottles*

Customers engage far more with people than with pure product.

WHAT THIS LOOKS LIKE

- Staff recommendations & expertise
- Behind-the-scenes moments
- Store culture & personality
- Local community involvement
- Real conversations about products

INSIGHT 02

Educational *Content*

Shoppers are overwhelmed by choice. Content should help them decide before and during a visit.

WHAT THIS LOOKS LIKE

- Cocktail recipes
- Food & drink pairings
- “What should I bring?” occasion picks
- Seasonal drink ideas
- Education for every knowledge level

INSIGHT 03

Videos *& Reels*

Short-form video remains one of the most effective ways to reach new customers on Instagram.

WHAT THIS LOOKS LIKE

- Staff mixing a cocktail
- New arrivals hitting the shelf
- Quick product recommendations
- Tasting prep & setup
- Store walkthroughs



THE STRONGEST TAKEAWAY

Customers engage with *people*, more than products.

Successful independent stores put their staff, regulars, and neighbors at the center of the feed, so this strategy does too.

Marketing *Objectives*

Clear goals designed to strengthen community, increase visibility, and drive store traffic.

OBJECTIVE 01

Build *Community*

Strengthen the store’s relationship with existing customers while creating opportunities to connect with new visitors.

SUCCESS INDICATORS

- Post & story interactions
- Direct messages & conversations
- Event participation
- Engagement with local businesses

OBJECTIVE 02

Awareness *& Reach*

Help more local customers discover the store, and give existing customers a reason to stay connected.

SUCCESS INDICATORS

- Follower growth
- Reel views
- Reach & profile visits
- Website visits & clicks

OBJECTIVE 03

In-Store *Participation*

Turn attention into action: store visits, event attendance, and discovering products they might not otherwise have bought.

SUCCESS INDICATORS

- Event attendance
- Traffic during promotions
- Customer feedback
- Sales tied to featured products

Content *Pillars*

Core content categories that guide a consistent and engaging social presence.



PILLAR 01

35%

Education
& *Discovery*

Cocktail recipes, wine recommendations, food pairings, and product education that will help customers find something new.

PILLAR 02

30%

Community
& *Personality*

The people behind the store: staff picks, behind-the-scenes moments, local brand partnerships, and event coverage.

PILLAR 03

25%

Products
& *New Arrivals*

Interesting inventory, limited releases, and seasonal arrivals, framed around discovery rather than a hard sell.

PILLAR 04

10%

Events
& *Engagement*

Tastings, community events, polls, quizzes, and contests that invite followers to participate in-store and online.

A weekly *rhythm*

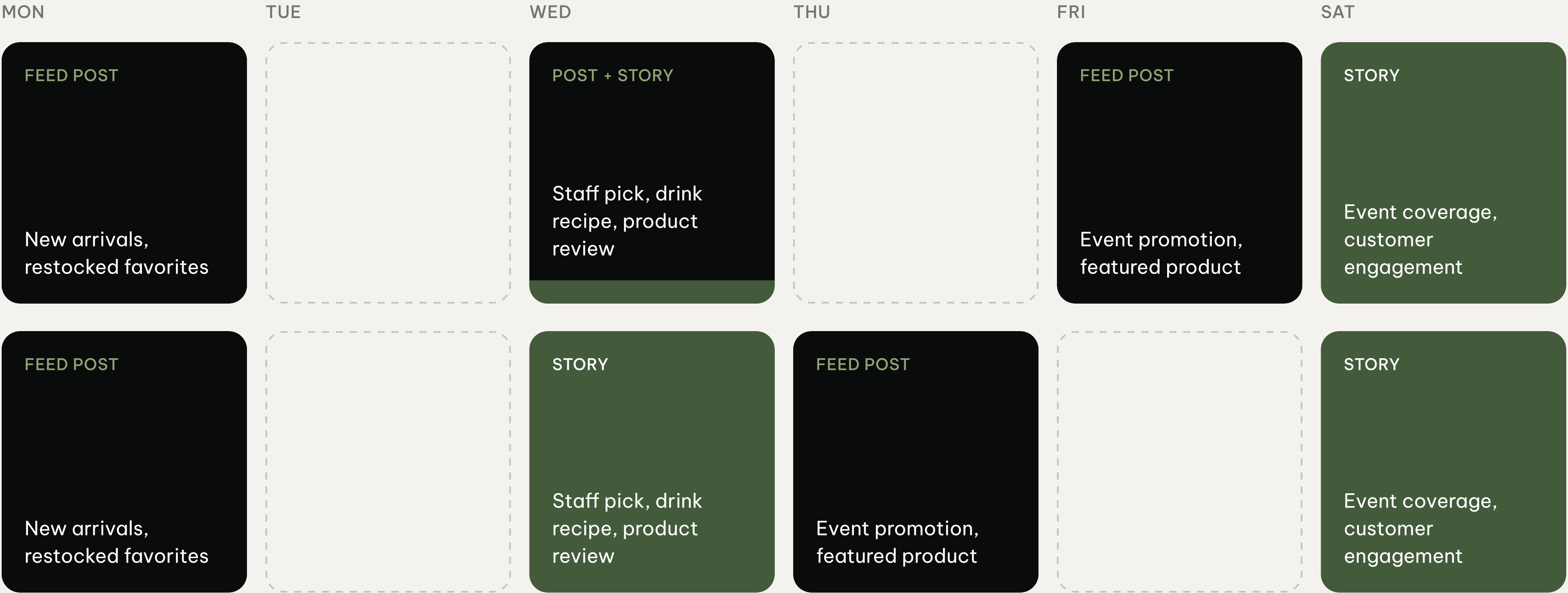
Consistent posting works with Instagram’s algorithm to reach more viewers and drive interaction with events and links.

RESEARCH-SUGGESTED

Three feed posts a week plus stories, the cadence recommended across industry sources.

ADJUSTED FOR LAUNCH

Ease in with 2–3 posts a week, staggered with stories, then build toward the full rhythm.



■ FEED POST ■ STORY

Stories run almost daily as the casual side of the account: staff picks, polls, quizzes, and event reminders. Schedules flex with store analytics and customer feedback.

Beyond the *Feed*

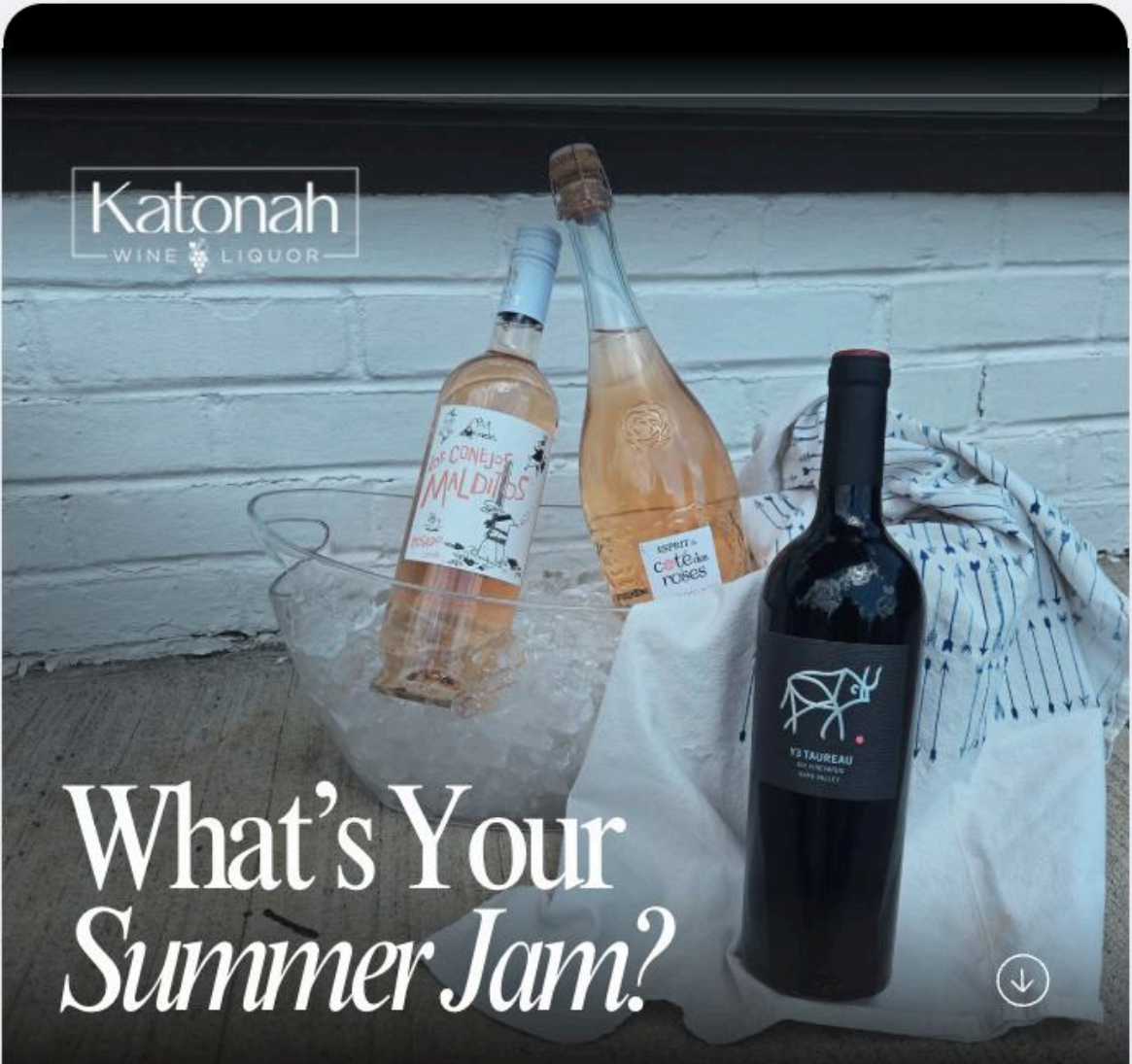
Email and print carry the same visual system off Instagram, so the brand feels consistent whether someone is scrolling, opening their inbox, or standing in the shop.

01 EMAIL NEWSLETTER

A monthly email that brings the feed’s photography and type into subscribers’ inboxes, pairing seasonal features and new arrivals with the month’s tastings and events.

02 IN-STORE PRINT

Signage and tasting calendars that bring the same look into the shop and send customers back to Instagram with a scannable QR code.



The universe of beverages seems to keep expanding, wine and spirits majorly included.

Part of the challenge of having a retail store is filtering new products. We are proud to assert we are VERY picky at Katonah Wine & Liquor. In turn, we get super excited to put new wines and spirits on the shelves. Here is a quick roundup of what's brand new for the summer of 2026 in 10536...

Monthly Newsletter

EMAIL



Discover new products, upcoming tastings, and exclusive in-store updates on @katonahwineandliquor

Connect With Us

IN-STORE PRINT

Designing a *cohesive* grid

BRANDING

A black-and-white base with green and blue accents drawn from the photography, condensed serif headlines over clean sans-serif captions, and black gradients that bring each product forward.

STAGED PHOTOGRAPHY

Real inventory staged in the shop or against wood, stone, and linen backdrops, in place of repetitive bottle shots and stock imagery.



From the summer shoots: a picnic spread for new whites and the Wines of Chile tasting crate.

*All product content is reviewed against Instagram’s policies on promoting alcohol before posting.

The System *in Use*

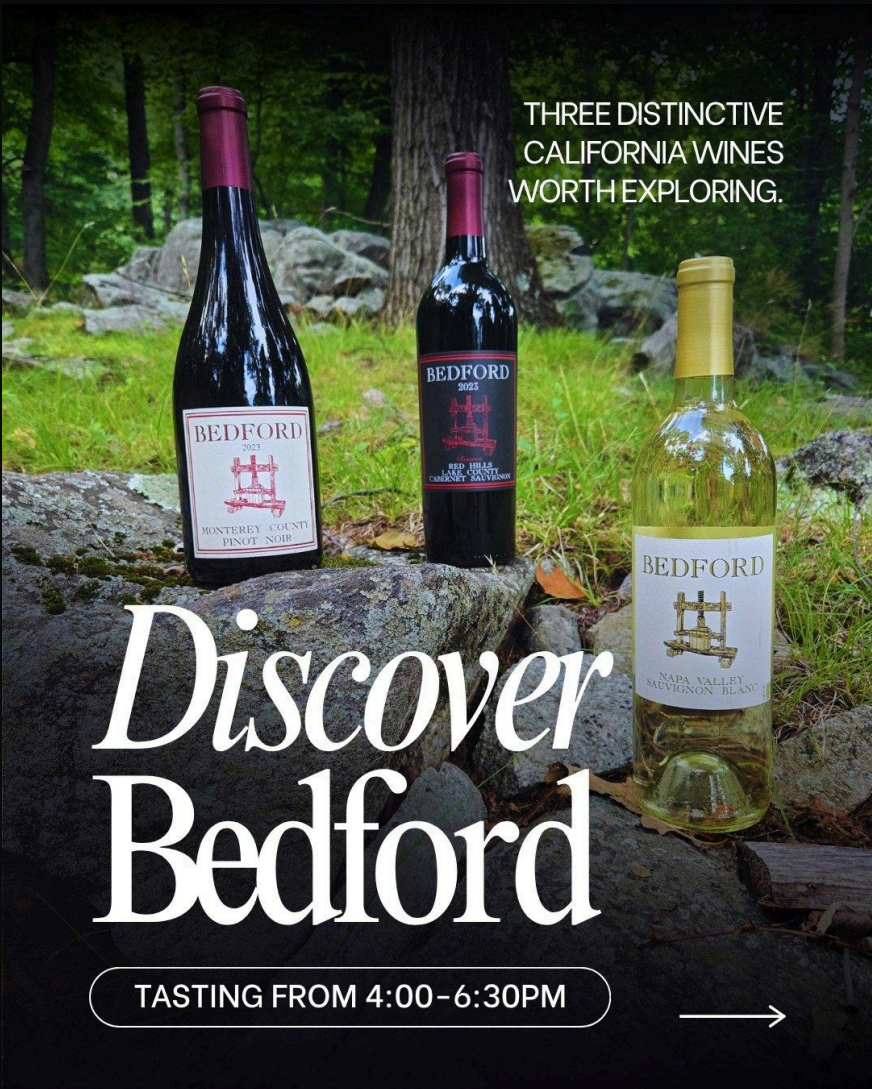
Applied from June through August 2026: carousel templates built on this strategy, with condensed serif headlines, clean sans captions, gradients that bring the product forward, and staged photography of real store inventory.



New Arrivals
PRODUCTS & NEW ARRIVALS



Napa Valley Sauvignon Blanc
EDUCATION & DISCOVERY



Discover Bedford
EVENTS & ENGAGEMENT



Bandol Rosé
EDUCATION & DISCOVERY



Wines of Chile
EVENTS & ENGAGEMENT

Beyond the Following

Reels quickly became by far the most popular content type, and transformed my posting approach for the rest of the summer.

50%+

Of views came from non-followers, reaching people who didn't yet know the store.

+20%

Growth in followers over the summer.

+40%

Growth in accounts reached.



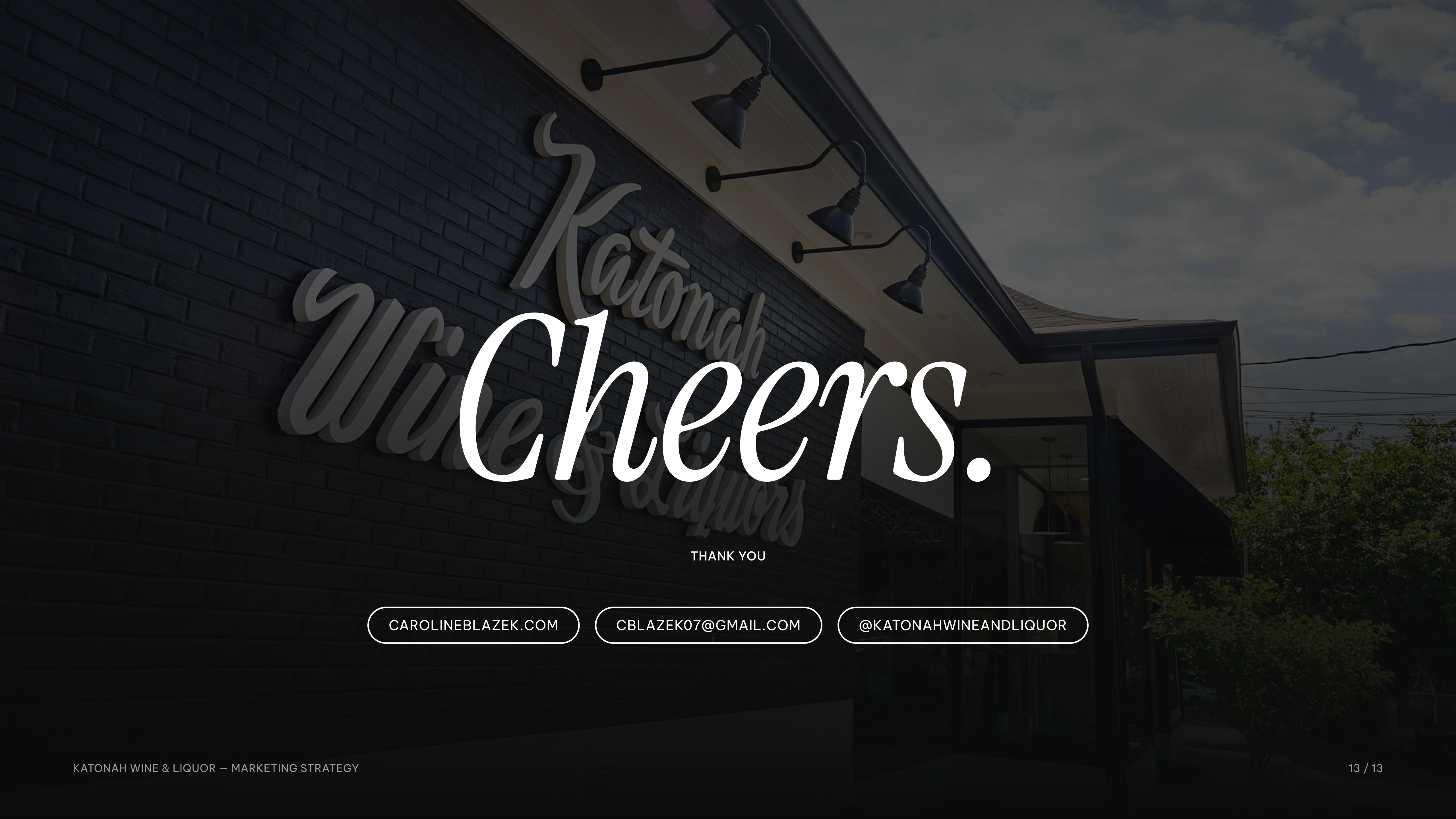
Kinda Chic
REEL



The Bee's Knees
REEL



No Place I'd Rather Be
REEL



Katonah Wine & Liquor Cheers.

THANK YOU

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